



## JUSTICE CENTER RELOCATION FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

Updated May 2026

### **Q: Safety is a concern for schools and neighborhoods near the proposed relocation site. What is the County going to do to address this concern?**

**A:** Safety is the County's top priority, whether at our current location or at a new location. The Sheriff's Office has approximately 500 employees. They provide security inside and outside of the jail, 24 hours a day. The new location and the surrounding area will experience an increased presence of law enforcement by the Sheriff's Office and municipal police departments, which will be a deterrent to crime. The County will work with the Sheriff's Office, the City of Georgetown (who has jurisdiction over the area), and the other police departments to ensure safety is a top priority for surrounding neighborhoods and schools.

### **Q: What will happen when inmates are released and there is not a public transportation system to get them back to their homes?**

**A:** Getting people back to their support systems is extremely important when releasing them from our facility. Currently, people are released from jail daily between 6 a.m. and 6 p.m. when resources are available to assist the person with transportation. These resources include use of a phone to call a family member or friend. Statistically, 93% to 95% of individuals released have a ride home.

### **Q: What other resources are available for individuals that do not have a ride arranged?**

**A:** For the small percentage of individuals that do not have a ride arranged, they are offered information on a Navigation Services program that is offered by a local non-profit organization that provides free in-county transportation services. In some circumstances, bus tickets or other transportation have been arranged to get individuals back to their families or residences. The County will continue to seek improvements and suggestions to provide a robust transportation system.

### **Q: What if individuals released do not use the transportation resources and want to remain in the areas surrounding the proposed jail?**

**A:** There is a lack of support services within the area of the new location (retail, food pantries, free internet, phone access and shelter). The likelihood of individuals staying near the jail after release is very low. Transportation needs of released inmates will be reviewed and improved when needed to ensure public safety is addressed.

### **Q: What happens if someone is arrested that has mental health problems and they are released near surrounding neighborhoods and schools?**

**A:** Williamson County collaborates with local police departments and partners with our local mental health authority, Bluebonnet Trails Community Services, to provide crisis services for those with mental health problems, which can include jail diversion for non-violent offenses. A Diversion Center for law enforcement has been created and operates away from the jail, which provides rapid assessments, medication management, crisis stabilization and transportation for adults. This helps avoid arrests and allows law enforcement to quickly get back on the streets. If a person with mental illness is identified after arrest, a care coordination plan and transportation will be provided.

**Q: What other resources are available in Williamson County for individuals in need of mental health services that could prevent incarceration?**

**A:** The County also has mental health as an option when calling 911 (Do you need police, fire, EMS or mental health?). There are mental health clinicians embedded in the 911 Communications Center that can provide crisis intervention, de-escalation and treatment coordination. The County also works with Bluebonnet Trails to provide Mobile Crisis Outreach Teams, respite centers for adults and youth, substance use and homeless prevention services, and access to psychiatric beds.

**Q: Why was this location selected for the relocation of the justice center and the jail?**

**A:** Williamson County formed a small committee of county elected officials, staff, and contracted consultants with expertise in this field to evaluate possible locations. The land had to have enough acreage to locate the justice courts and jail together for efficiencies. It also had to be large enough for future growth and to meet the demands of our high-growth county. A ranking system was created with over thirty criteria points to evaluate locations. Some of the criteria included driving time for law enforcement, distance from hospitals, response time for fire and EMS, infrastructure (water, wastewater and sewer) availability, and if there was a willing seller. It was narrowed down to three sites located along the S.E. Inner Loop in Georgetown. The land at 1200 CR 110 was determined to be the best location based on the criteria in the scoring matrix.

**Q: Why wasn't a more rural location selected for the justice center and jail relocation?**

**A:** More rural locations were evaluated, but they would require installation of extensive and costly infrastructure. Installation of infrastructure would greatly increase the costs of the justice center and jail construction. In addition, response times for emergency services would be increased, as well as drive times for law enforcement and the public.

**Q: Can the justice center be in the selected proposed location and put the jail in another more rural location?**

**A:** No, it has been determined that efficiencies and cost effectiveness can only occur with the jail and justice center in close proximity to each other. Separation of the jail and justice center creates duplication and increased costs at both locations. There would be a need for more full-time employees to provide security at both locations. With duplication of services, there would be an increase in personnel costs, which are the most expensive part of the County's budget. In addition, it would greatly increase transportation costs and complicate security during transport. Inmates involved in cases would need to be transported back and forth to the jail. There would also be additional costs for vehicles, and associated costs.

**Q: Why was the selection process handled internally by elected officials, staff and consultants and the public not involved sooner?**

**A:** Due to the significant costs of real estate transactions, the Texas Legislature allows the process and negotiations to be held in private. When government is involved in purchases, prices are often increased by sellers. Proceeding with site selection with the internal Relocation Subcommittee allowed the County to protect taxpayers and avoid artificially increased land prices. The County has an appraiser review the selling price before offering a bid. The value of the property on the Williamson Central Appraisal District website is artificially low due to its current agriculture use status and does not reflect its market price.

**Q: I am worried that my property values for my home will be negatively impacted by construction of a justice center and jail near my home.**

**A:** The current jail near downtown Georgetown was built in the late 80s/early 90s. Property values have increased substantially since then, along with commercial businesses, tourism and additional homes. For example, a single-family residential home with 1,329 square feet located near the current jail has increased in value from \$248,924 in 2021 to \$429,866 in 2025. This is an increase in property value of 73%. Homesites within 1,000 feet of the jail are being bought and demolished to construct high-value homes in their place. The new jail location will have an advantage that will help protect property values because there will be larger arterial streets separating it from neighborhoods.

**Q: Can the area handle increased traffic, infrastructure and utility needs?**

**A:** During the site assessment process, utility requirements and capacity were reviewed. The site has the ability to meet the needs of the new jail. Traffic improvements are being planned in the area by the City of Georgetown, including the expansion of the S.E. Inner Loop from SH 29 to FM 1460. This roadway is planned to be a four-lane, divided minor arterial that will help improve safety and mobility in the area, while creating separation from nearby subdivisions.

**Q: How can I provide comments and suggestions as the Justice Complex Project moves forward?**

**A:** Public comment and input is always taken and appreciated when doing projects in Williamson County. For questions or comments please email [publicinformation@wilcotx.gov](mailto:publicinformation@wilcotx.gov).